

Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Year A

PC-S36-A

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	cf. Ps. 28:8–9
Collect	<i>Sancti nominis tui... timorem pariter et amorem</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	Jer. 20:10–13
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 69:8–10, 14, 17, 33–35; response 14c
Second Reading	Rom. 5:12–15
Gospel Acclamation	John 15:26b, 27a
Gospel	Matt. 10:26–33
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over Offerings	<i>Suscipe... sacrificium placationis et laudis</i>
Communion Antiphon	A: Ps. 145:15; B: John 10:11, 15
Prayer after Communion	<i>Sacri Corporis et Sanguinis pretiosi alimonia renovati</i>

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Jeremiah hears hostile whispering yet entrusts his cause to God; Jesus commands disciples to bear witness without servile fear; Paul contrasts Adam's trespass with Christ's overflowing gift.
Allegorical	Christ is the faithful witness; unselected Communion B also names him as the Good Shepherd who gives his life. In him the Church receives the Spirit, confesses publicly, and is fed at one table.
Moral	Courage is truthful fidelity under providence, not emotional invulnerability or reckless exposure. Holy fear and love displace servile terror while preserving prudence and justice.
Anagogical	What is concealed will be disclosed; God remembers the whole person, raises hope beyond bodily death, and brings Christ's superabundant gift toward final redemption.

Scriptural Date and Location

Canonical order governs; composition and narrated event remain distinct, and inherited and modern judgments remain separate where the evidence is uncertain.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
Entrance	Ps. 28:8–9	Israel; exact composition place unknown	Traditional Davidic attribution; historical date uncertain
Davidic title; historical author, site, and date unrecoverable. Divine majesty yields to the Lord as his people's strength and his inheritance's shepherd; the Entrance appoints that pastoral conclusion.			
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 69:8–10, 14, 17, 33–35	Israel; Jerusalem imagery, precise writing site unknown	Traditional Davidic attribution; historical date uncertain
Davidic lament: reproach, zeal, petition, and praise of the poor coexist. The appointed verses omit much imprecation and autobiography; the canonical context remains relevant but is not inserted into the proclamation.			
Comm. A	Ps. 145:15	Israel's worship; exact place unknown	Davidic title; historical date uncertain
Davidic-titled acrostic praise confesses God's kingship, compassion, justice, and creaturely provision. Communion A appoints eyes turned to God for food.			
First Reading	Jer. 20:10–13	Judah / Jerusalem; final book shaped through later transmission	Prophetic event late seventh or early sixth century BC
The book identifies Jeremiah's ministry through Judah's final decades; its final form passed through later transmission. The event follows Pashhur's beating and confinement. Confidence stands amid complaint and later curse: courage is not uninterrupted calm.			
Gospel	Matt. 10:26–33	Canonical Gospel: traditional Palestine; modern Antioch proposal uncertain	Traditionally early apostolic period; modern majority c. AD 80–90
Narrated event	Matt. 4:23; 10:1–33	Galilee; exact speaking site unrecorded	Public ministry, c. AD 28–29
Tradition: the Apostle Matthew writing for Jewish believers. Modern judgment: the canonical Greek Gospel after AD 70. Event horizon: within the missionary discourse, persecution precedes Jesus' repeated command not to fear.			
Comm. B	John 10:11, 15	Canonical Gospel: traditional Ephesus; modern history debated	Late first century
Narrated event	John 9:1–10:21	Jerusalem ministry	c. AD 29
The Good Shepherd discourse contrasts Jesus' self-gift with a hireling's abandonment. Communion B receives the shepherd who knows the sheep and lays down his life.			
Acclamation	John 15:26b, 27a	Canonical Gospel: traditional Ephesus; modern history debated	Late first century
Narrated event	John 13:1; 15:18–27	Jerusalem, final supper	c. AD 29–30
Amid the world's hatred, Jesus promises that the Spirit bears witness and the disciples testify. The acclamation welcomes the Gospel's demand for public acknowledgment.			
Second Reading	Rom. 5:12–15	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece), to churches at Rome	c. AD 56–58
Paul addresses mixed Jewish and Gentile churches at Rome. The boundary opens the Adam–Christ comparison and stops before its elaboration. The gift is “not like” the trespass: grace exceeds, rather than balances, sin's devastation.			

The Propers: Themes and Movement

Governing account: witness under providence, grace beyond trespass

Jeremiah and Matthew form the Lectionary's official witness-under-persecution relation; Psalm 69 answers it in lament and praise, and John 15 acclaims the Spirit's testimony. Romans proceeds independently from Adam's trespass to Christ's greater gift, while the Missal surrounds both strands with holy fear and love, reconciliation and praise, shepherding nourishment, and promised renewal.

Affliction named → fear reordered → witness confessed → life received

1. Affliction is spoken before courage (*Jeremiah, Psalm*)

Jeremiah's confidence comes from within hostility, not above it. Psalm 69 likewise preserves reproach, petition, zeal, and praise of the poor. Their liturgical relation refuses two reductions: suffering is neither proof of abandonment nor an emotion to suppress. Trust can ask for deliverance while naming danger truthfully.

2. Fear is reordered by knowledge and love (*Collect, Gospel*)

The Collect holds fear and love together around God's holy name. Matthew distinguishes fear of persecutors from reverence for the One who judges and preserves the whole person. Chrysostom reads sparrows and numbered hairs as assurance of exhaustive divine knowledge, while denying that every creaturely fall is positively caused by God.

3. Witness belongs to Spirit and disciple (*Acclamation, Gospel, Romans*)

John's acclamation gives priority to the Spirit's testimony and then names the disciples' witness. Jesus requires public acknowledgment without promising immunity. Romans independently declares a still deeper disproportion: humanity's solidarity in Adam is answered not by an equal counterweight but by Christ's abundant gift. Courage is therefore graced fidelity, not personality or bravado.

4. The Shepherd feeds toward redemption (*Entrance, Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Entrance and Communion option B supply shepherd language; option A names creaturely dependence for food. The offering prayer joins reconciliation and praise, while the concluding prayer names renewal by Christ's Body and Blood. These shared Week XII texts can frame fearless witness sacramentally, but their use across A/B/C prevents a claim that they were composed for Matthew 10.

Pastoral control

"Do not be afraid" never commands concealment of abuse, refusal of lawful protection, medical neglect, or reckless self-exposure. Providence includes creaturely causes and prudent action. Christian witness may be costly, but suffering is not sought as an end and perpetrators are not excused as instruments of God.

Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

These texts present courage as graced witness rather than emotional invulnerability. Jeremiah speaks trust from within affliction; Christ orders fear through divine judgment and providential care; the acclamation gives priority to the Spirit's testimony before the disciple's confession. Romans places every act of witness beneath Christ's gift, whose abundance exceeds Adam's trespass.

Holy fear and love therefore sustain truthful fidelity together with prudence and justice. The Entrance and the two Communion antiphons name strength, provision, and the Good Shepherd's self-gift, while the offering and post-Communion prayers move through reconciliation, praise, nourishment, and renewal. Their horizon is the disclosure of truth, care for the whole person, and final redemption in Christ.

Dimension	Appointed anchors	Source-grounded synthesis	Limit
Christological	Matt. 10:26–33; Rom. 5:12–15; Communion B	Christ is the faithful witness and Good Shepherd whose self-gift exceeds Adam's trespass and grounds the disciple's public confession.	Romans remains a semi-continuous strand, and the Good Shepherd antiphon is an unselected alternative rather than a text enacted in every Mass.
Providential	Jer. 20:10–13; Ps. 69; Gospel	The threatened prophet, afflicted psalmist, and commissioned disciples entrust truth and the whole person to God's exhaustive knowledge and judgment.	Providence does not mean that God positively causes abuse, persecution, or every creaturely fall; lament, protection, and prudent action remain legitimate.
Ecclesial and sacramental	John 15:26b, 27a; Prayer over Offerings; Prayer after Communion	The Spirit's testimony precedes ecclesial witness, while reconciliation, praise, nourishment by Christ's Body and Blood, and renewal order confession within received worship.	The acclamation welcomes the Gospel rather than becoming another reading; the Week XII orations serve A/B/C and do not prove one compositional design.
Moral and eschatological	Collect; Jeremiah; Gospel; Romans; Prayer after Communion	Holy fear and love sustain truthful fidelity without servile terror, under the promise that truth will be disclosed and Christ's greater gift tends toward final redemption.	Courage is not emotional invulnerability, reckless exposure, concealment of abuse, or contempt for bodily life and lawful protection.

The Propers: Detailed Commentary

Strength, shepherding, and holy fear (*Entrance, Collect*)

The Entrance adapts Psalm 28's closing confession: the majestic Lord is also strength, refuge, savior, and shepherd. The image protects courage from self-reliance. The people facing witness are an inheritance carried by another, not a heroic elite sustained by temperament.

The full psalm moves through storm imagery and repeated attribution of glory before reaching this pastoral conclusion. Augustine's *Exposition on Psalm 28* receives that movement sacramentally and ecclesially: the mighty voice that shakes creation is not separated from the Lord who gives strength and peace to his people. Whatever one makes of each allegorical detail, the broad sequence prevents a sentimental shepherd image. Divine care belongs to the same holy majesty before which human strength is relativized. The antiphon adapts the closing verses; it does not appoint Augustine's allegory or the complete psalm.

The Collect's paired fear and love rejects both servile terror and sentimental familiarity. Reverence recognizes God's holiness and judgment; love cleaves to his name and trusts his governance.

Jeremiah's lament and Matthew's disclosure (*First Reading, Psalm, Gospel*)

Jeremiah hears denunciation from every side, even from those watching for his fall. Yet he submits his cause to the One who tests the just and sees inward truth. The reading ends in praise, but the surrounding chapter proceeds into curse and anguish. Scripture therefore permits the persecuted believer to confess trust without pretending that trauma produces simple emotional serenity.

Jerome's *Commentary on Jeremiah*, book IV, comments directly on 20:9–13 in Latin. He treats the unspoken word as a fire that the prophet cannot contain, sees surrounding reproach as a trial familiar to teachers, and notices that former friends wait for a fall. At verse 11 he reads the Lord's presence as that of a strong warrior; at verse 12 he does not sanitize the prophet's wish to see vindication, but identifies the human frailty and impatience disclosed by it. At verse 13 he assigns the rescue to grace rather than personal merit. Jerome's reading is not the final word on prophetic psychology, but its verse-by-verse attention guards three features easily lost in thematic summaries: compelled speech, betrayal by intimates, and praise that credits God rather than the sufferer's prowess.

Jerome's sequence also prevents two opposite appropriations. Because the word has become inward fire, Jeremiah cannot be reduced to a speaker who simply chose controversy; because Jerome names impatience in the desire for visible vengeance, prophetic vocation does not place every affect or inference beyond judgment. The Lord who tests heart and mind is the prophet's defender and examiner. This combination makes the reading usable for ecclesial self-critique: threatened witnesses may seek God's judgment, while communities must still test whether speech, motive, and desired remedy accord with the God invoked.

The selected verses begin with conspiracy rather than the preceding account of the word burning within Jeremiah, and they stop at praise before the curse of the prophet's birth. Consulting both contexts is necessary. The liturgy proclaims a real confession of deliverance; commentary must not extend that boundary into a claim that Jeremiah's anguish has already ended. Jerome's sequence itself confirms how closely confidence and impatience stand together.

Psalm 69 answers in the first person. Reproach touches the servant because of zeal for God's house; the petition seeks an answer in divine kindness; the poor are finally summoned to praise. Augustine's ecclesial and Christological reception hears the suffering Christ and his body in the psalm, but it does not erase the lament's Israelite voice or prove the later Lectionary pairing's history.

Augustine's direct exposition repeatedly passes between Christ the head and suffering members, especially where reproach for God's cause is concerned. That reception explains why Christian tradition can pray the lament christologically without claiming that every historical detail originally described Jesus. It also resists a cult of solitary heroism: the voice of the afflicted is heard within a body, and the psalm's final summons lets the poor join praise. The responsorial use is officially correlated with Jeremiah; Augustine supplies reception of the psalm, not evidence about that modern pairing.

Matthew's repeated prohibition of fear is reasoned. What is concealed will be disclosed; disciples cannot finally secure truth through silence. Human persecutors possess limited power. God knows creatures down to sparrows and hairs,

and Christ will acknowledge those who acknowledge him. These claims establish divine judgment and care, not present immunity.

Chrysostom's *Homily 34 on Matthew* distinguishes the reasons Christ gives rather than reducing them to repetition. Hidden truth will be manifested; enemies cannot kill the soul; providence attends creatures of very small market value; and Christ will confess his confessors before the Father. Courage therefore arises from truth about the limits of persecuting power and the scope of divine knowledge. It is not an assertion that bodies do not suffer. Chrysostom's further comment that providence does not mean God positively causes every sparrow's fall is especially important: divine care is not a vocabulary for calling violence good.

Cyprian's *Testimonies* III.4 later gathers Matthew 10:28 and the confession sayings for communities formed under the possibility of persecution. This is martyrial reuse rather than continuous exposition. It shows that the passage became a grammar of public fidelity, but it cannot be transferred without qualification to every disputed speech or private danger. Confession concerns Christ and truth under grace; it does not forbid prudent withdrawal, legal protection, or safeguarding.

The official first-reading–Gospel correlation should be stated with equal care. Jeremiah's enemies watch for a misstep; Matthew's disciples are told that concealed truth will be disclosed and that Christ will acknowledge faithful confessors. These motifs genuinely converse in the Lectionary. They do not turn Jeremiah into a coded prediction of Matthew 10, nor do they make every institutional conflict a prophetic persecution. The texts themselves supply tests: Jeremiah submits his cause to the God who sees heart and mind, while Jesus orders fear by divine judgment. Neither authorizes a speaker to declare himself righteous merely because he is opposed.

Chrysostom's distinction is precise: nothing falls outside God's knowledge and providential ordering, yet the text does not require saying that God positively effects every sparrow's fall. Catholic doctrine likewise distinguishes divine first causality, creaturely causes, permission of evil, and God's ability to bring good without making evil good. That distinction is decisive whenever this Gospel is preached to vulnerable persons.

The Spirit's testimony and the disciple's speech (*Acclamation*)

John 15 places witness amid hatred and expulsion. The Spirit of truth testifies to Christ; disciples also testify because they have been with him. The acclamation therefore protects Matthew 10 from individualism. Public confession is ecclesial and pneumatological before it is a test of private nerve. The verse welcomes Christ's Gospel word; it is not another semi-continuous reading.

Augustine's *Tractate 92 on John* expounds John 15:26–27 directly. He does not set the Spirit's testimony against the apostles' speech: the Spirit bears witness and makes them capable of bearing witness. Peter's passage from fearful denial to public confession provides Augustine's concrete example. The reception sharpens the acclamation's grammar. "You also testify" is not autonomous courage added alongside divine action; apostolic testimony is enabled from within by the promised Spirit and grounded in having been with Jesus. Since the acclamation quotes only parts of the two verses, its liturgical function remains a concise welcome to the Gospel rather than a substitute reading of the farewell discourse.

The gift is not like the trespass (*Second Reading*)

Romans 5:12–15 begins a dense comparison whose grammar continues beyond the appointed boundary. Paul traces sin and death through Adam and then interrupts any expectation of equal symmetry: Christ's gracious gift is not like the trespass. Chrysostom emphasizes this excess. One act's devastation becomes the occasion for displaying a gift whose abundance cannot be represented as a mere zero-sum cancellation.

Aquinas's *Commentary on Romans* V, lectio 3, attends to the difficult opening comparison and to Paul's interruption before the completed Adam–Christ parallel. The entrance of sin and death names a solidarity no individual created alone, while the gift comes through the one man Jesus Christ in an abundance not measured by the offense. Augustine's *Against Two Letters of the Pelagians* IV.8 joins Romans 5:10–12 in an anti-Pelagian argument: those needing reconciliation are not merely neutral creatures lacking instruction, and grace cannot be reduced to natural capacity. Both are direct later receptions with their own controversies. Neither licenses treating inherited sin as personal blame for another's deed, nor does either erase Paul's insistence on the superabundance of Christ's gift.

Verse 12's final clause has generated major grammatical and doctrinal debate, but the appointed reading itself

immediately supplies a corporate horizon: sin enters through one, death spreads, and all sin. The guide therefore refuses two reductions—an account of Adam that makes personal sins irrelevant, and an individualism that cannot name a wounded solidarity preceding personal choice. The reading’s decisive word is nevertheless not an abstract anthropology but the contrasting gift in verse 15. Paul introduces Adam to magnify Christ’s abundance, not to leave the assembly contemplating ruin as the last reality.

The appointed reading ends at verse 15, before Paul completes several contrasts. This boundary makes humility especially necessary. The congregation hears the universality of death and the decisive inequality between trespass and gift; it does not hear the whole subsequent account of judgment, justification, obedience, and reigning grace. Commentary may consult those verses to follow Paul’s grammar but should not silently place them in the proclamation.

This apostolic strand remains semi-continuous. It should not be forced into an allegory in which Adam equals persecutor or Christ equals Jeremiah. Its liturgical contribution is plural: the same assembly hearing the demand for witness also hears that salvation originates in a gift exceeding inherited ruin.

Reconciliation, praise, and nourishment (*Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings identifies the sacrificial movement as reconciliation and praise while asking that those offering be purified. Worship is therefore not a bribe paid by the endangered, nor a reward for courage; it is God’s reconciling gift received and returned in praise.

Communion option A places every creature before the giver of food. Option B names the Good Shepherd whose self-gift distinguishes him from the hireling who abandons the flock. The Prayer after Communion then asks renewal through the precious Body and Blood toward redemption. The alternatives thus emphasize either creaturely dependence or the Shepherd’s sacrificial care while converging in Christ’s nourishing gift.

Augustine’s *Exposition on Psalm 145* receives the first branch’s praise as a schooling away from trust in mortal rulers and toward the Creator who feeds, frees, raises, and keeps faith. The antiphon selects the eyes of all and God’s timely gift of food; its psalmic context locates nourishment within a larger pattern of justice and care. That context prevents the verse from becoming a prosperity promise and prevents Eucharistic use from erasing ordinary creaturely dependence.

The verse’s universal gaze also resists an exclusively inward Eucharistic reading: creatures await sustenance from their maker, and sacramental nourishment trains rather than abolishes attention to hungry bodies. Augustine’s full-psalm reception places food among God’s faithful acts toward the oppressed and bowed down. The antiphon remains one branch, but its context makes gratitude socially answerable.

For option B, Augustine’s *Tractate 46 on John* directly distinguishes the Good Shepherd, who gives his life, from the hireling, who flees when the wolf comes. *Tractate 47* then treats the exact continuation in John 10:14–15. Christ knows his own and knows the Father; other shepherds act only as his members and enter through him, while his self-offering establishes their pattern without making them alternative doors. The appointed antiphon joins knowledge and self-gift, so pastoral familiarity without costly care is inadequate, as is sacrifice without truthful knowledge of the flock.

Cyril of Jerusalem’s *Catechetical Lecture 10*, section 5, receives the same saying christologically: Christ is sheep according to the humanity in which he is offered and Shepherd according to divine loving-kindness. Gregory Nazianzen’s *Oration 18* uses the shepherd’s knowing, defending, and guiding of the flock as a pastoral measure. Augustine supplies direct exposition; Cyril and Gregory supply illuminating reuse. Together they make Communion B more than a generic picture of kindness: the Shepherd’s care is self-giving, discerning, and answerable for the flock. None of this identifies which alternative was enacted.

The Propers: Notable and Quotable

Jeremiah: *Nova Vulgata*, Jer. 20:11 (editio typica altera, 1986). (*First Reading*) “*Dominus autem mecum est quasi bellator fortis;*” The appointed confession locates courage in God’s presence, not temperament. Its military image neither promises bodily immunity nor authorizes retaliation.

St. Jerome, *Commentary on Jeremiah IV*, on Jer. 20:13, Latin text, Migne, PL 24 (1845). (*First Reading*) “*Hoc autem totum fit, non nostro merito, sed ejus gratia qui pauperem liberavit.*” Rescue is grace rather than merit. Jerome’s spiritual and moral reception does not exhaust Jeremiah’s historical situation or turn deliverance into a prosperity promise.

St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 34 on Matthew*, sec. 2, trans. George Prevost, rev. M. B. Riddle, NPNF1 10 (1888). (*Gospel*) “*He does not promise them deliverance from death, but permits them to die.*” Christian courage is not bodily invulnerability. The same homily permits flight from persecution; the line cannot commend reckless exposure, concealment, or abuse.

St. Augustine, *Tractate 92 on John*, sec. 2, trans. John Gibb, NPNF1 7 (1888). (*Acclamation*) “*For He, in bearing witness Himself, and inspiring such witnesses with invincible courage, divested Christ’s friends of their fear.*” Witness begins in Christ and receives courage from him. It does not make every inward impulse self-authenticating.

The Propers: Interpretive Possibilities

Editorial status

The following exploratory proposals were developed in an AI-assisted editorial process. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities and claim no historical compositional intent. Each states its anchors and limits.

The whispering circuit is broken by rooftop speech. (*First Reading; Acclamation; Gospel*) Jeremiah hears hostile whispers and invitations to denounce; the acclamation names the Spirit’s testimony and the disciples’ derivative witness; Matthew moves concealed and darkened speech onto housetops. This spatial-verbal reversal breaks the persecutor’s communications circuit: truth answers rumor not by imitation but by reception from God and public accountability. Separate reading misses the movement from enclosed surveillance through divine testimony to open acknowledgment. Its fruit for preaching, journalism, whistleblowing, and institutional truth-telling is courage joined to verifiability and nonretaliation. No checked source joined all three anchors. The Spirit’s aid neither certifies every impulse, abolishes preparation or confidentiality, requires reckless disclosure, nor removes duties to protect sources and vulnerable persons.

Two kinds of watching assign opposite meanings to visibility. (*First Reading; Gospel*) Jeremiah’s intimates watch for a misstep; Matthew’s Father knows a sparrow’s fall and a threatened disciple’s hairs. Both minutely observe vulnerability, but hostile watching turns detail into leverage while divine knowing establishes worth and courage. Separate reading can leave Providence abstract and persecution external, missing the moral difference between surveillance awaiting failure and attention that makes no small life negligible. The fruit is an audit of pastoral records, digital monitoring, safeguarding data, and interpersonal attention: information serves care only where power answers to the person’s good. Jerome and Chrysostom treat the strands separately; no exact precedent was located. Divine knowledge is not human data collection or positive causation of every fall and never excuses privacy, consent, or protection duties.

The one heard as poor is valued as sparrow and known as sheep. (*Responsorial Psalm; Gospel; Communion B*) Psalm 69 says God hears the needy; Matthew’s slight sparrow denies that threatened witnesses are forgotten; Communion B, if appointed, names the Shepherd who knows his sheep and gives his life for them. The chain intensifies visibility into relation: hearing distress becomes recognition of irreducible worth, then self-giving knowledge. Separate reading misses divine attention becoming the pattern by which pastoral authority spends itself. The fruit is safeguarding and social care whose records, reporting, aid, and presence serve the vulnerable person rather than institutional reputation. Early shepherd texts offer near analogues, not this exact chain. Communion B is unresolved; Providence promises no immunity, “sheep” does not infantilize, and care requires competent systems rather than sentiment alone.

A surplus of grace can interrupt inherited fear. (*Second Reading; Gospel*) Romans traces sin and death through Adam yet makes Christ's gift more than an equal counterweight: grace abounds. Matthew names bodily threat, limits the killer's reach, and demands acknowledgment of Christ. Without claiming official correlation, this asymmetry suggests that inherited familial, cultural, or institutional fear is real yet not sovereign where a more abundant gift creates allegiance. Separate reading can leave Adam–Christ remote from public courage and “do not fear” to willpower; the connection grounds courage in received excess. Its fruit is communal resistance to fear's inherited scripts. Chrysostom's unequal-gift reading and ancient martyrial use of Matthew are near analogues, not this account. Paul offers no clinical or sociological theory; grace never replaces trauma-informed care, prudent flight, legal protection, or truthful danger assessment.

The Communion branches distinguish provision from recognition. (*Communion A; Communion B*) Communion A, if chosen, shows Psalm 145's eyes awaiting food; Communion B, if chosen, the Shepherd's knowledge and self-gift. Without blending alternatives into one enacted antiphon, comparison reveals care's two dimensions: dependable provision answers bodily dependence; personal knowledge and accountable presence resist reducing persons to need categories. Separate treatment notes Eucharistic aptitude but misses the branch structure's critique of systems without relationship and relationships without provision. Augustine on the psalm and early Shepherd reception offer near analogues, not this exact comparison. The fruit is integrated pastoral design. Selection is unknown, neither branch is a complete social program, and sacramental gift cannot be reduced to either humanitarian supply or therapeutic recognition.

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Formula and occurrence	PC-S36-A; Sunday Mass for the Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time; 21 June 2026; green.
Books and territory	<i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> , English for the United States (implemented 2011), and U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Second Typical Edition, Volume I, no. 94.
Calendar and cycle	U.S. implementation of the General Roman Calendar; Sunday Year A.
Formulary and textual scope	Ordinary Time Week XII. Its shared audit owns the Missal formulary; this leaf owns the dated Year A composition and its two Communion-antiphon alternatives.

Branch Resolution

Branch ID	Authority and trigger	Status	Units affected	Resolution
communion-antiphon-psalm-145	Week XII formulary	Appointed alternative	Psalm 145 option	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-john-10	Week XII formulary	Appointed alternative	John 10 option	Documented, not selected

Appendix: Scope and Qualifications

Instance: instance/manifest.md. **Leaf composition audit:** propers/verified.md. **Canonical formulary owner:** ../shared/ordinary-time/weeks/12/propers/verified.md. **Research audit:** research/scope.md. **Coverage:** the complete formula and branches, every appointed scriptural unit, immediate contexts, and a passage-by-passage reception search were studied. Retained direct witnesses include Jerome, Chrysostom, Augustine, and Aquinas; Cyprian, Cyril, and Gregory are marked where they furnish illuminating reuse rather than continuous exposition. **Negative result:** no early Greek continuous treatment of the exact Jeremiah 20:10–13 unit was retained from the accessible corpora checked; Jerome supplies a direct Latin witness. **Limits:** no exhaustive manuscript, untranslated-corpus, subscription-database, or proper-calendar survey is claimed. Complete U.S. English altar-book oration collation and independent theological review remain outstanding.

References

- USCCB, Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time, 21 June 2026, U.S. Lectionary 94; and 2026 Liturgical Calendar, accessed 2026-07-15.
- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (2002), pp. 462–463; reimpressio emendata (2008); and *Roman Missal, Third Edition*, U.S. English edition implemented 2011.
- Bishops’ Conference of England and Wales, *Antiphony: Excerpted from the Roman Missal* (ICEL, 2010), pp. 72–73, used as official corroboration of the common ICEL antiphons, not as a substitute U.S. altar book.
- *General Instruction of the Roman Missal* 46–90; *General Introduction to the Lectionary* 65–69, 78–91, 93–110.
- Holy See, *Nova Vulgata Bibliorum Sacrorum Editio*, editio typica altera (1986), Jeremiah 20:11, official Latin wording checked 2026-07-18.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 34 on Matthew* and *Homily 10 on Romans*.
- St. Jerome, *Commentary on Jeremiah*, book IV, on Jer. 20:9–13 (Latin).
- St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 28*, *Exposition on Psalm 69*, *Exposition on Psalm 145*, *Tractate 92 on John*, *Tractate 46* and *Tractate 47 on John*, and *Against Two Letters of the Pelagians* IV.8.
- St. Thomas Aquinas, *Commentary on Romans* V, lect. 3; St. Cyprian, *Testimonies* III.4; St. Cyril of Jerusalem, *Catechetical Lecture 10*, sec. 5; St. Gregory Nazianzen, *Oration 18*.
- *Catechism of the Catholic Church* 302–314 and 402–412; Council of Trent, Session V.

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; **unexposed:** exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (notable-and-quotable primary-source verification, wording, rights, and locus audit, compact reader-facing insertion, and final layout correction); API workspace; unexposed: client version, interface, and server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (structural audit, document-revision, and production roles); Codex CLI 0.144.5; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (reader-order structural revision: moved and retitled the unchanged scriptural chronology and location sheet and set its page boundaries); Codex CLI 0.144.5; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (one-page scriptural dossier compaction and source-level fit-audit role); API workspace; unexposed: client version, interface, and server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agent (passage-level reception research, commentary expansion, and source audit); API workspace; unexposed: client version, interface, and server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (interpretive-discovery proposals, targeted conjunction searches, bounded novelty-audit, interpretive-proposal compression, provenance correction, and page-fit audit roles); API workspace; unexposed: client version, interface, and server revision

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